BURIAL AT SEA PORT CHECKLIST

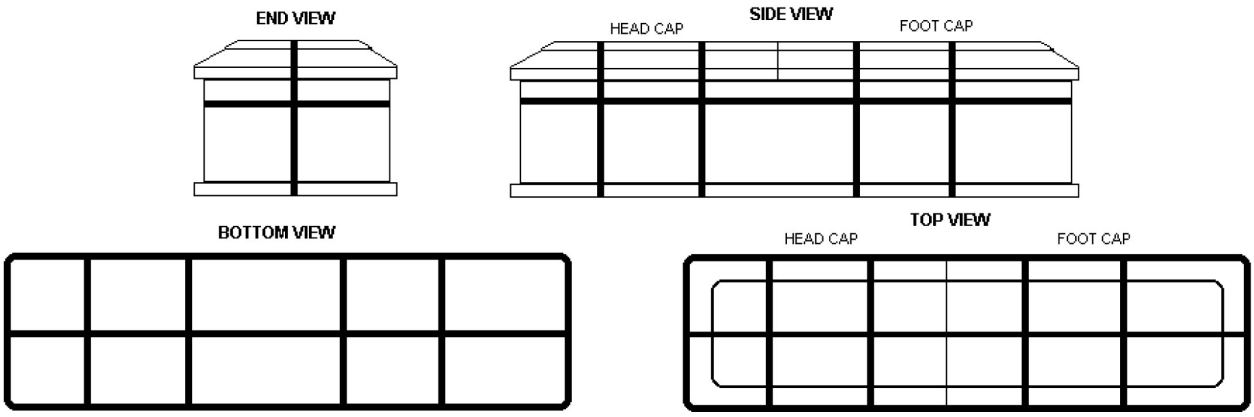
III. GUIDELINES FOR CASKET PREPARATION *(to be completed by the Receiving Funeral Home)*

WEIGHTING

Add 150 lbs. of weight to the foot-end of the casket to ensure “feet first” sinking. Sandbags are best. However if lead weights are used, secure them to the inside of the casket to avoid them shifting around and causing excessive noise.

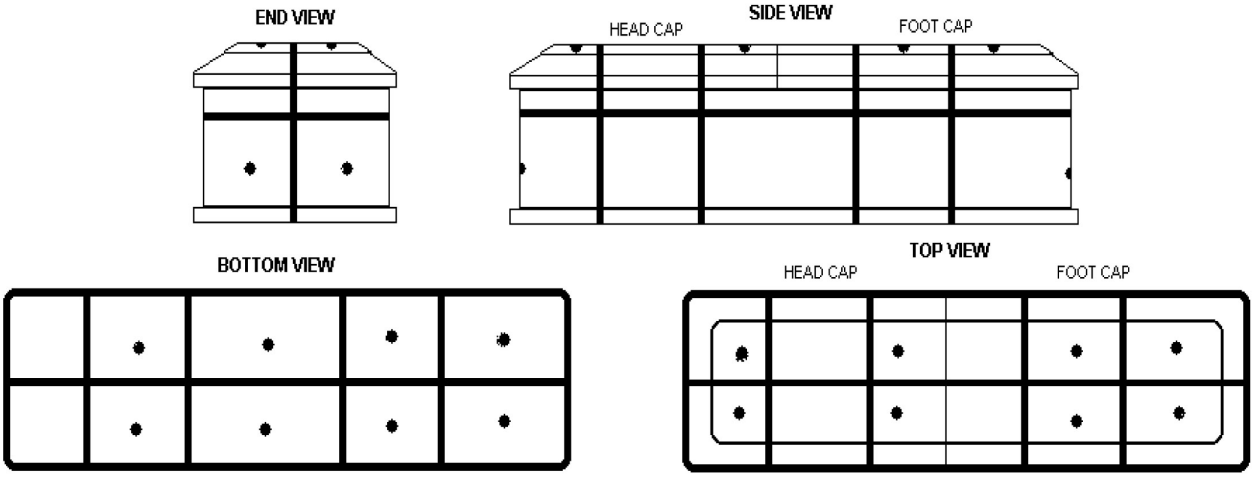
BANDING

The casket is to be banded with a minimum of six (6) nylon or metal bands, at least ¾ of an inch wide. The bands are to be placed: two around the head panel; two around the foot panel; one lengthwise, head-to-foot; and one horizontally around the sides. **NOTE**: Ensure bands are placed under the casket handles to allow continued use of handles.



HOLES

A total of 20 holes, 2-inches in diameter, are to be drilled in the casket. There are to be eight holes in the top of the casket, with four in the head panel; four in the foot panel; eight in the bottom; and two in each end.



If you require additional guidance for preparation of the casket, please don’t hesitate to contact the Navy-Marine Corps Mortuary Affairs, toll-free at 1-866-787-0081 and follow the voice menu.
Email: NAVMORT@navy.mil